Problem 3 | Problems T5_MechanicalProperties.pdf #3 | Tensile test · true stress and strain · design

Tensile Test of a 13 mm Sample: Modulus, Cable Section and True Values at Maximum Load and Fracture

Original statement · Problems T5_MechanicalProperties.pdf, p. 2

3. An uniaxial tensile test was performed on a cylindrical sample of 13 mm in diameter getting the results of load and elongation shown in the table below:

- *a. Calculate the engineering stress and strain values and draw the stress-strain curve.*
- *b. Calculate the value of the elastic modulus (Young's Modulus) and determine the length of a bar of 13 cm on which a tension of 200 MPa is applied.*
- *c. What is the recommended cross-section for a cable that has to support an elevator with a maximum weight of 450 kg?*
- *d. Calculate the real stress and real strain values at maximum load and at the fracture point, assuming that the diameter of the sample is 12.922 mm and 10.348 mm respectively. Do the calculations without using the engineering stress and strain values.*
- *e. Calculate the modulus of resilience.*
- *f. Calculate the elastic strain at the moment before fracture.*

Point	Load (kg)	Calibrated length (mm)	Engineering stress (MPa)	Engineering strain
0	0	5.148		
1	500	5.151		
2	1500	5.156		
3	2500	5.161		
4	3500	5.166		
5	3750	5.225		
6	3950	5.354		
7	4000	5.457		
8	4000	5.560		
9	3600	5.676		

(In the sheet the table has only the first two columns filled; the last two are left blank to be completed in item a. Point 0 is the unloaded sample, points 7 and 8 have the same, maximum, load, and point 9 is the fracture.)

Official Solution: **b.** $E = 75.4$ **GPa,** $l = 13.04$ **cm;** **c.** $A_0 \geq 16.9$ **mm²;** **d. maximum load:** $\sigma_{UTS} = 300$ **MPa,** $\varepsilon_{UTS} = 0.012$**; fracture:** $\sigma_{fracture} = 420$ **MPa,** $\varepsilon_{fracture} = 0.456$**;** **e.** $U_r = 0.457$ **MPa;** **f.** $\varepsilon_y = 3.4 \times 10^{-3}$

HYPOTHESES & PARAMETERS

Hypotheses

1. **Uniaxial, uniform stress** up to the necking: engineering stress and strain with the original area and length [Session 11 Slide 9].
2. **Weight to force.** The loads are masses in kilograms; the force is $F = m\,g$ with $g = 9.81$ m/s².
3. **Linear elastic start** [Session 11 Slide 13] and **0.2 % offset yield strength** [Session 11 Slide 28].
4. **Calibrated length.** The first row ($m = 0$) gives the initial length $l_0 = 5.148$ mm and the other rows the current length. The strain is a ratio, so only the proportion matters.
5. **True quantities from the measured diameters** (item d). The true strain is $\varepsilon_r = \ln(A_0/A) = 2\ln(D_0/D)$ and the true stress is $\sigma_r = F/A$ with A the instantaneous area [Session 11 Slide 38]. They are valid also after the necking, because they use the actual area at the neck.
6. **Design stress (item c).** The statement does not give a safety factor. The minimum section is the one for which the cable does not yield, $\sigma = F/A_0 \le \sigma_y$; with the usual factor $N = 2$ it would be larger [Session 11 Slide 29].

Data

Quantity	Symbol	Value	In SI
Diameter	d_0	13 mm	13×10^{-3} m
Initial calibrated length	l_0	5.148 mm	5.148×10^{-3} m
Gravity	g	9.81 m/s²	
Bar of item b: length, stress	l_b, σ	13 cm, 200 MPa	0.13 m, 200×10^{6} Pa
Elevator (item c)	m	450 kg	
Diameter at maximum load, at fracture	D_m, D_f	12.922 mm, 10.348 mm	

Unknowns: the curve (a), E and the length of the bar (b), the section of the cable (c), the true stress and strain at maximum load and at fracture (d), U_r (e), the elastic strain before the fracture (f).

MODEL & STRATEGY

One direction (the axis) and uniaxial stress: there is no change of basis.

Strategy. The table is converted into $\sigma_n = F/A_0$ and $\varepsilon_n = (l - l_0)/l_0$. Then:

- E is the slope of the straight part (least squares through the origin), and the bar of item b is a direct application of Hooke's law, $\Delta l = (\sigma/E)\, l_b$.
- σ_y by the 0.2 % offset is needed twice: for the cable (c) and for the resilience (e).
- The true values (d) are computed from the forces and the measured diameters, as the statement asks, and not from the engineering values.
- The elastic strain before the fracture (f) is σ/E with the stress that acts at that moment [Session 11 Slide 32].

STEP-BY-STEP CALCULATION

1. Cross-section and conversions

$$A_0 = \frac{\pi d_0^2}{4} = \frac{\pi\,(13\ \text{mm})^2}{4}$$

With $13^2 = 169$ and $\pi \times 169 = 530.93$:

$$A_0 = 132.73\ \text{mm}^2$$

For the first loaded point, $F_1 = 500\ \text{kg} \times 9.81\ \text{m/s}^2 = 4\,905\ \text{N}$, so

$$\sigma_{n,1} = \frac{4\,905\ \text{N}}{132.73\ \text{mm}^2} = 36.95\ \text{MPa} \qquad \varepsilon_{n,1} = \frac{5.151 - 5.148}{5.148} = 0.00058$$

a) Engineering stress and strain, and the curve

All the points:

Point	Load (kg)	l (mm)	$F = mg$ (N)	σ_n (MPa)	ε_n	σ_n/ε_n (GPa)
0	0	5.148	0	0.00	0	—
1	500	5.151	4 905	36.95	0.00058	63.4
2	1500	5.156	14 715	110.86	0.00155	71.3

Point	Load (kg)	l (mm)	$F = mg$ (N)	σ_n (MPa)	ε_n	σ_n/ε_n (GPa)
3	2500	5.161	24 525	184.77	0.00253	73.2
4	3500	5.166	34 335	258.68	0.00350	74.0
5	3750	5.225	36 788	277.16	0.01496	18.5
6	3950	5.354	38 750	291.94	0.04002	7.3
7	4000	5.457	39 240	295.63	0.06002	4.9
8	4000	5.560	39 240	295.63	0.08003	3.7
9	3600	5.676	35 316	266.07	0.10256	2.6

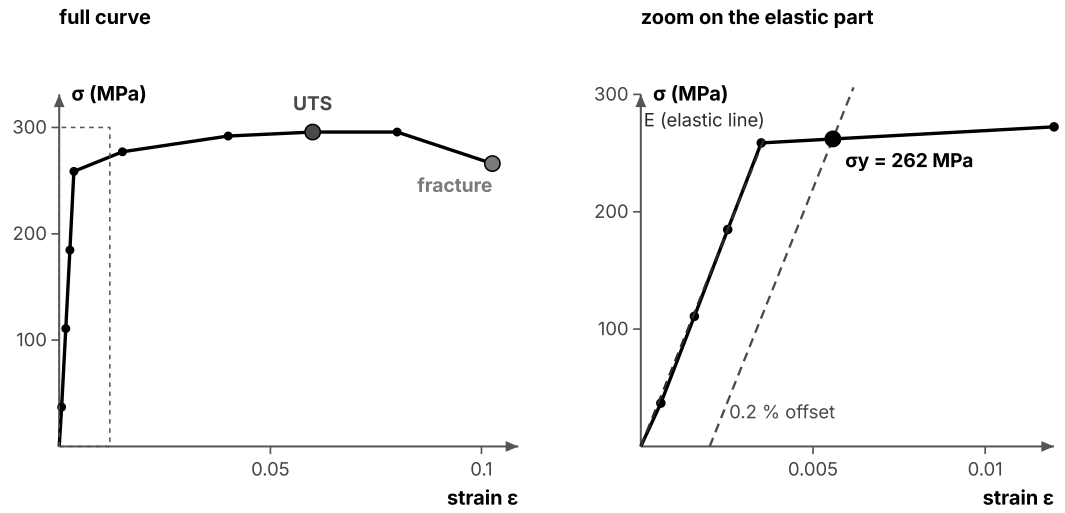


Figure 3. Problem 3: engineering stress-strain curve built from the data of the sheet (every dot is a table row), with the elastic line and the 0.2 % offset construction.

b) Young's modulus and the length of the bar

The secant modulus of the last column grows from 63 to 74 GPa in points 1 to 4 and falls to 18 GPa at point 5: the linear zone ends after point 4. The first value is lower because a strain of 0.0006 comes from an elongation of only 0.003 mm, at the limit of the resolution of the table. The fit through the origin on points 1 to 4 is:

Point	ε_i	σ_i (MPa)	$\sigma_i\varepsilon_i$ (MPa)	ε_i^2
1	0.00058	36.95	0.0215	3.396×10^{-7}
2	0.00155	110.86	0.1723	2.415×10^{-6}
3	0.00253	184.77	0.4666	6.377×10^{-6}
4	0.00350	258.68	0.9045	1.223×10^{-5}

$$E = \frac{\sum \sigma_i \varepsilon_i}{\sum \varepsilon_i^2} = \frac{1.565}{2.1357 \times 10^{-5}} = 73273 \text{ MPa} = \mathbf{73.3\ GPa}$$

For the bar, the strain produced by $\sigma = 200$ MPa is $\varepsilon = \sigma / E$ and the elongation is $\Delta l = \varepsilon\, l_b$:

$$\varepsilon = \frac{200}{73273} = 0.002730 \qquad \Delta l = 0.002730 \times 130 \text{ mm} = 0.355 \text{ mm}$$

$$l = l_b + \Delta l = 130 + 0.355 = 130.355 \text{ mm} = \mathbf{13.04\ cm}$$

c) Section of the cable

The yield strength is needed first. With the offset line $E(\varepsilon - 0.002)$ the sign of $g = \sigma_n - E(\varepsilon_n - 0.002)$ changes between points 4 and 5:

Point	ε_n	σ_n (MPa)	$E(\varepsilon_n - 0.002)$ (MPa)	$g = \sigma_n - E(\varepsilon_n - 0.002)$ (MPa)
3	0.00253	184.8	38.5	146.3
4	0.00350	258.7	109.7	149.0
5	0.01496	277.2	949.4	-672.3
6	0.04002	291.9	2785.5	-2493.6

$$m = \frac{277.16 - 258.68}{0.01496 - 0.00350} = 1612.2 \text{ MPa} \qquad \varepsilon^* = \frac{258.68 - 1612.2 \times 0.00350 + 0.002 \times 73273}{73273 - 1612.2} = \frac{399.587}{71660.3} = 0.0055761$$

$$\sigma_y = E\,(\varepsilon^* - 0.002) = 73273 \times (0.0055761 - 0.002) = \mathbf{262.0\ MPa}$$

The weight of the elevator is $W = 450 \times 9.81 = 4414.5$ N. For the cable not to yield, $W / A_0 \le \sigma_y$:

$$A_0 \geq \frac{W}{\sigma_y} = \frac{4414.5\ \text{N}}{262.0\ \text{N/mm}^2} = \mathbf{16.85\ mm^2}$$

If the usual safety factor $N = 2$ is also applied, the design stress is $\sigma_y/2$ and the section doubles, $A_0 \geq 33.7$ mm².

d) True stress and strain at maximum load and at fracture

Maximum load. $F_m = 4000 \times 9.81 = 39\,240$ N and $D_m = 12.922$ mm:

$$A_m = \frac{\pi\,(12.922)^2}{4} = \frac{\pi \times 166.978}{4} = 131.14\ \text{mm}^2$$

$$\sigma_{r,UTS} = \frac{F_m}{A_m} = \frac{39\,240}{131.14} = \mathbf{299.2\ MPa} \qquad \varepsilon_{r,UTS} = 2\ln\frac{D_0}{D_m} = 2\ln\frac{13}{12.922} = 2\ln(1.00604) = 2 \times 0.006018 = \mathbf{0.01204}$$

Fracture. $F_f = 3600 \times 9.81 = 35\,316$ N and $D_f = 10.348$ mm:

$$A_f = \frac{\pi\,(10.348)^2}{4} = \frac{\pi \times 107.081}{4} = 84.10\ \text{mm}^2$$

$$\sigma_{r,f} = \frac{F_f}{A_f} = \frac{35\,316}{84.10} = \mathbf{419.9\ MPa} \qquad \varepsilon_{r,f} = 2\ln\frac{13}{10.348} = 2\ln(1.25628) = 2 \times 0.22816 = \mathbf{0.4563}$$

e) Modulus of resilience

$$U_r = \frac{\sigma_y^2}{2E} = \frac{(262.0\ \text{MPa})^2}{2 \times 73273\ \text{MPa}} = \mathbf{0.469\ MPa}$$

f) Elastic strain before the fracture

The stress of the table at the fracture point (point 9) is $\sigma_n = 266.1$ MPa, and the elastic part of the strain is given by Hooke's law:

$$\varepsilon_e = \frac{\sigma_n}{E} = \frac{266.1}{73273} = \mathbf{3.63 \times 10^{-3}}$$

RESULT & CHECKS

Checks

- **Units.** Masses in kg and g in m/s² give newtons, N/mm² is MPa, the strains have no units, and $A_0 \geq W/\sigma_y$ comes out in mm².
- **Order.** The true stress at maximum load (299.2 MPa) is above the engineering maximum (295.6 MPa) because the area has shrunk, and the true fracture stress (419.9 MPa) is much above the engineering one (266.1 MPa), while the engineering stress falls after the maximum.
- **Limit.** For $D = D_0$ the true strain $2\ln(D_0/D)$ is zero and the true stress is F/A_0, the engineering one.
- **Bar.** The elongation, 0.355 mm over 130 mm, is a strain of 0.27 %, well inside the elastic zone (the yield strain is 3.58 × 10⁻³ = 0.36 %).

Interpretation

The sample is a ductile metal with a clear yield at 262.0 MPa and a long hardening plateau up to 295.6 MPa; the neck makes the true stress at fracture 419.9 MPa. The cable needs at least 16.85 mm² to stay elastic under the elevator, and about twice as much with the usual safety factor.

DIAMETERS AND LENGTHS OF THE TABLE DO NOT DESCRIBE THE SAME STRAIN

At the maximum load the length of the table gives $\varepsilon_n = 0.0600$, that is, $\varepsilon_r = \ln(1+\varepsilon_n) = 0.0583$ with the uniform-deformation relation, and constant volume would give a diameter $13/\sqrt{1+\varepsilon_n} = 12.63$ mm. The statement gives 12.922 mm, with $\varepsilon_r = 0.01204$. At the fracture, $A_0/A_f = 1.578$ while $l/l_0 = 1.1026$. The two sets of data do not describe the same deformation: the diameters measure the strain of the neck, the lengths the average over the calibrated length. The statement asks to compute the true values from the diameters, and that is what is done.

Check against the official solution

Item	Official	Computed	Comment
b. E	75.4 GPa	73.3 GPa	agrees (3 %)
b. length of the bar	13.04 cm	13.04 cm	agrees
c. A_0	≥ 16.9 mm²	≥ 16.85 mm²	agrees: the key uses σ_y without safety factor
d. $\sigma_{r,UTS}$, $\varepsilon_{r,UTS}$	300 MPa, 0.012	299.2 MPa, 0.01204	agrees

Item	Official	Computed	Comment
d. $\sigma_{r,f}$, $\varepsilon_{r,f}$	420 MPa, 0.456	419.9 MPa, 0.4563	agrees
e. U_r	0.457 MPa	0.469 MPa	agrees (2.5 %): the key uses $E = 75.4$ GPa
f. elastic strain	3.4×10^{-3}	3.63×10^{-3}	differs 7 %

DISCREPANCY WITH THE OFFICIAL SOLUTION: ELASTIC STRAIN BEFORE THE FRACTURE

The key gives 3.4×10^{-3}. With the stress of the table at the fracture, 266.1 MPa, and the fitted modulus the elastic strain is 3.63×10^{-3}; with the key's modulus, 75.4 GPa, it is 3.53×10^{-3}. The yield strain, $\sigma_y / E = 3.58 \times 10^{-3}$, is also not the key value. The value cannot be reproduced exactly, and the computed one is kept.